SCHEME OF WORK

Week	Topic
1	Revision of Tenses in Grammar; Narrative Essay: My Holiday Experience
2	Conditional Clauses; Complex Sentences; Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Publishing; Essay Writing: Speech Writing, Meaning and Features
3	Speech Work: Stress Patterns; Structure: Active and Passive Voice; Vocabulary Development: Prefixes; Essay Writing: Article Writing
4	Structure: Prepositional Phrase; Vocabulary Development: The Use of Dictionary; Grammar: Rules of Concord
5	Speech Work: Stress Placement on Two or More Syllable Words; Essay writing: Story Writing; Comprehension: Reading for the Writer's purpose
6	Structure: Adjectival Clause; Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Films and TV; Summary Writing
7	Speech Work: Vowels /I/ & /I:/; Essay Writing: Expository - Raising a Total Child; Comprehension: Identifying Sentence Types; Structure: Adverbs
8	Vocabulary Development: Hotel & Catering; Structure: Prepositional Phrases; Summary Writing: Summarising for Implied Meaning
9	Structure: Idioms; Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Politics and Government; Descriptive Essay: A Festival I Like
10	Structure: Affixation (Suffixes); Speech Work: Nasal Sounds (/m/ /n/ and /ŋ/); Vocabulary Development: Transportation

Week	Topic
11	Structure: Clauses - Subordinate and Insubordinate; Speech work: Stress on the 5th and 6th syllables; Reading for Implied Meaning
12	Examination / Revision

COURSE CONTENT

WEEK 1

TOPICS: GRAMMAR: REVISION OF TENSES; NARRATIVE ESSAY: MY HOLIDAY EXPERIENCE

Grammar: Tenses

Tense is a term which applies to verbs, and it is used to indicate the time of an action: past, present, or future.

- **The Past Tense:** Used to express a past action. Regular verbs take ‘ed’ or ‘d’ (voted, waited, preached). Irregular verbs change form (built, threw, said, swam, set).
- **The Present Tense:** Used to express the current time. It must agree with the subject in a sentence (vote, wait, say, preach, elect).
- **The Future Tense:** Expressed by putting an auxiliary or specific structure before the verb:
  - Will + verb (e.g., I will go tomorrow).
  - Shall + verb (e.g., I shall visit you next week).
  - Be + going (e.g., I am travelling next year).
  - Be + -ing verb (e.g., She is coming next month).
  - Be + about to + verb (e.g., They are about to start the lecture).
  - Progressive form of verbs (e.g., The bus leaves tonight).

Narrative Essay: My Holiday Experience

- **Features:** Use the past tense, arrange events chronologically, use connectors/transitional expressions, raise suspense, describe people/places/events, and use figurative language or proverbs.
- **Outline:**
  - Write your title boldly in capital letters.
  - Make your introduction interesting; indicate when the holidays started.
  - Describe how you felt at the prospect of a holiday.
  - Mention where and with whom you spent the holiday.
  - Disclose what happened, your reactions, the interesting parts, and annoying ones.

- Reveal the lessons learnt in the conclusion.

WEEK 2

TOPICS: CONDITIONAL CLAUSES; COMPLEX SENTENCES; VOCABULARY: PUBLISHING; ESSAY WRITING: SPEECH WRITING

Conditional Clauses

A conditional sentence has at least two clauses, one beginning with if (or 'unless' which means 'if …. Not'). The 'if clause' is the subordinate clause while the result clause is the main clause.

- **Likely or probable conditionals:**
  - Present simple in both clauses: *If you have a life insurance policy, your family has financial protection.*
  - Present simple in if-clause, future tense in result clause: *With your policy, the insurance company will pay up, even if you drive into a tree.*
- **Unlikely or Remote conditional:** Past tense (subjunctive) is used in the if-clause, "would" in the result clause. *If you left the keys in the car and if it were stolen, the insurance company would probably not pay you.*
- **Unfulfilled or impossible conditional:** Used for talking about what did not happen. Past perfect tense in the if-clause and "would have" + past participle in the result clause. *If I had left the keys in the car, the insurance company would not have paid up.*

Complex Sentences

A complex sentence consists of one main clause and one or more subordinate clauses. (All conditional clauses are complex sentences).

- *If I were your father* (Sub. Cl.), *I would punish you* (M. cl.).
- *Since I came to this school* (Sub. Cl.), *I have never been punished* (M. cl.) *because I always obey the rules* (Sub. Cl.).

Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Publishing

- **Publishing:** The business of preparing and printing books, magazines, etc., and making them available to the public.
- **Manuscript:** Copy of a book before it has been printed.

- **Reader:** A worker in a publishing house who reads a manuscript to see if it will appeal to the public.
- **Author:** A person who writes books.
- **Edition:** The form or number of copies of a book or magazine.
- **Revised Edition:** A published book in which the author has added new ideas or eliminated obsolete concepts.
- **Hardback or Paperback:** A book's hard outer covering or a light outer covering.
- **Review:** An examination of something with the intention of changing it if necessary.
- **Imprint:** The name of the publisher of a book usually printed below the title on the first page.
- **Copyright:** A statement showing the person who holds publication rights, forbidding unauthorised duplication.

Essay Writing: Speech Writing

A written composition expected to be delivered to a live audience. Types include Address of Welcome, Farewell Address/Speech, and a Talk on any Topic.

- **Features:**
  - The title follows a specific pattern (e.g., A FAREWELL SPEECH DELIVERED BY [NAME], [TITLE], ON [EVENT] AT [VENUE] ON [DATE]).
  - Dignitaries are greeted in their order of hierarchy (e.g., The Proprietor, The Principal, The PTA Chairman, Parents, Members of Staff, Students, Ladies and Gentlemen).
  - Appreciate the privilege to address the gathering.
  - Logically discuss your points, describe impressions, discuss impacts, and challenge the audience.
  - Use formal language with occasional humour.

WEEK 3

TOPICS: SPEECH WORK: STRESS PATTERNS; STRUCTURE: ACTIVE AND PASSIVE VOICES; VOCABULARY: PREFIXES; ESSAY WRITING: ARTICLE WRITING

Speech Work: Stress Patterns (Morphophonemic Approach)

Stress placement is determined by the occurrence of vowels and consonants in syllables.

- **Two-syllable Adjectives, Adverbs, and Prepositions:**
  - Stress the first syllable when the second syllable contains a short vowel and one or a final consonant (ENter, ENvy, Open, Equal). Exceptions: verbs ending in /əu/ are stressed on the first syllable (FOllow).
  - Stress the second syllable if it contains a long vowel or diphthong and ends with more than one consonant (withDRAW, inVITE, aLIVE).
- **Three-syllable Verbs:**
  - If the last syllable contains a long vowel, diphthong, or more than one consonant, stress it (resuRRECT, enterTAIN).
  - If the last syllable contains a short vowel, stress the second syllable (deTERmine).
- **Nouns of Two Syllables:** Stress the first syllable if the second contains a short vowel; otherwise stress the second (MOney, PROduct vs. balLOON, deSIGN).
- **Nouns of Three Syllables:**
  - If the middle syllable contains a long vowel or ends with more than one consonant, stress the middle (poTAto, diSASter).
  - If the last syllable contains a short vowel and not more than one consonant, stress the first syllable (QUANtity, EXercise, CUStody).

Structure: Active and Passive Voices

When the performer comes before the verb, the verb is in the active voice. When the subject represents the sufferer of the action, it is in the passive voice.

- **Active:** Dairo killed a snake.
- **Passive:** A snake was killed by Dairo.
- **Rules for Changing Active to Passive:**

- Exchange positions between the subject and the object.
- The tense of both voices must remain the same.
- Introduce the preposition ‘by’ in the passive voice.
- Introduce a form of the verb ‘BE’ in the passive voice.

Vocabulary Development: Prefixes

A prefix is attached to the front of a root word to form another word, changing its meaning.

- **un-** (not): unhappy, untrue
- **dis-** (not): discomfort, dislike
- **non-** (not): nonsense, non-smoker
- **mis-** (wrong): mismanage, mislead
- **mal-** (bad): malfunction, maltreat
- **super-** (exceeding): supernatural, superman
- **out-** (exceed): outdo, outlive
- **sub-** (below): substandard, subhuman
- **hyper-** (beyond): hypertension, hyperactive
- **anti-** (against): anti-social, antiviral

Essay Writing: Article Writing

Writing meant to be published in school magazines, a newspaper, or a journal.

- **Features:** Must have a heading, an introductory paragraph, a body of at least three well-developed paragraphs, and a concluding paragraph (minimum 5 paragraphs total).
- Must contain your full name and your class, school, or town at the end.

WEEK 4

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE; VOCABULARY: USE OF DICTIONARY; GRAMMAR: RULES OF CONCORD

Structure: Prepositional Phrase

A group of words which begins with a preposition and ends with a noun, pronoun, or noun phrase (its complement).

- **Types:**
  - Preposition + Noun: *He is in trouble.*
  - Preposition + Pronoun: *Please, bear with me.*
  - Preposition + Noun Phrase: *She is always yelling at the girls.*
  - Preposition + Wh-clause: *He was surprised at what she told his friend.*
  - Preposition + ing-clause: *He needs a truck for transporting gravel.*
- **Grammatical Functions:**
  - Modifier (Adjective): *The man with a hat is our teacher.*
  - Modifier (Adverb): *The police caught the thief in the garden.*
  - Complement of a Verb: *We believe in what you said.*
  - Complement of an Adjective: *We are sure of his chances.*

Vocabulary Development: The Use of Dictionary

A dictionary gives a list of words in alphabetical order, their meanings, spellings, pronunciations, usage, stress, collocations, and word classes.

- **Structure:** Word entry (syllable breakdown), Transcription (phonetic symbols), Stress marks, Word class, Numbering for different meanings, and English Variety (BrE, NAmE).
- **Abbreviations:** Pl (Plural), C (Countable), U (Uncountable), Syn (Synonym), Ant (Antonym), Idm (Idiom), Fig (Figurative), Tech (Technical), Opp (Opposite), PHRV (Phrasal verb), Sth (Something).

Grammar: Rules of Concord

Concord is the agreement of the subject with the verb in a sentence.

- When the subject is third person singular, the present verb takes ‘s’ or ‘-es’ (e.g., Monica listens).
- For first person, second person, and third person plural, the base plural verb is used (e.g., We go, They make).
- In a noun phrase, the verb must agree with the head word (e.g., One of my students has travelled).
- Two singular nouns connected by ‘and’ expressing the same person/idea take a singular verb (e.g., Rice and beans is my best food).
- Two nouns connected by ‘and’ referring to different things take a plural verb (e.g., My friend and my brother have arrived).
- Words starting with ‘each’, ‘every’, ‘either’, or ‘neither’ take a singular verb (e.g., Every man and woman has his own destiny).
- When two nouns are connected by ‘or’/‘nor’, the verb agrees with the noun closest to the verb (e.g., Either Temi or her sisters are interested).
- Indefinite pronouns and nouns ending in ‘s’ but singular in meaning take singular verbs (e.g., Everybody is here; Politics is a dirty game).

WEEK 5

TOPICS: SPEECH WORK: STRESS PLACEMENT; ESSAY WRITING: STORY WRITING

Speech Work: Stress Placement

(Review of Week 3 Stress Placement rules: Two-syllable nouns, verbs, adjectives, and three-syllable structures.)

Essay Writing: Story Writing

A description of events and people invented to advocate or entertain (e.g., adventure, sci-fi).

- **WAEC/NECO Types:** A story to illustrate a particular saying, or a story that ends with a specific expression.
- **Basic Features:**
  - Must have a heading in capital letters (Do not use the exam prompt's expression as the heading).
  - An introductory paragraph serving as the beginning.
  - A body containing at least three well-developed paragraphs showing complication.
  - A concluding paragraph acting as the resolution or dénouement.

WEEK 6

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: ADJECTIVAL CLAUSE; VOCABULARY: FILMS AND TV

Structure: Adjectival Clause

An adjectival clause performs the function of an adjective (qualifies a noun). It begins with a relative pronoun (who, which, that, whose, where, whom).

- **Defining Relative Clause:** Not separated by a comma (e.g., *The boy whom you praised so well has been rewarded.*)
- **Non-Defining Relative Clause:** Marked off by commas, giving extra information (e.g., *Things Fall Apart, which was written by Chinua Achebe, is a best seller.*)

Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Films and TV

- **Slanting the news:** Expressing news in a biased way to mislead the public.
- **Censor:** To approve whatever is published or broadcast before it is made public.
- **Curtail:** Restrict.
- **Director:** A person who directs the performance of a movie.
- **Producer:** General control of money/logistics for a film or broadcast, without directing actors.
- **Box-office:** Office where seats are booked and tickets are paid for.
- **Rehearse:** To learn and practise something for later performance.
- **Star:** A famous or very skilful performer.
- **Audience:** The people listening to or watching a performance.
- **Curtain call:** Call made by the audience to an actor at the end of a play to acknowledge applause.

WEEK 7

TOPICS: SPEECH WORK: VOWELS /I/ & /I:/; SENTENCE TYPES; STRUCTURE: ADVERBS

Speech Sounds: /I/ and /I:/ Contrasted

The /I:/ is the long vowel sound, while the /I/ is short.

- eat / it
- beat / bit
- seat / sit
- heel / hill
- feel / fill
- seen / sin
- leave / live
- wean / win
- meal / mill
- least / list

Identifying Sentence Types

- **Simple sentence:** One main clause (M1).
- **Complex sentence:** One main clause + two or more subordinate clauses (M1, S1 or more).
- **Compound sentence:** Two main clauses joined by a conjunction (M2).
- **Multiple sentence:** Three or more main clauses (M3 or more).
- **Compound-complex sentence:** Two or more main clauses + one or more subordinate clauses (M2 or more, S1 or more).

Structure: Adverbs

An adverb modifies a verb, an adjective, and/or another adverb. Most end in '-ly', formed from adjectives.

- **Functions:**

  - Modifying verbs: *Maureen runs fast.*
  - Modifying adjectives: *Taiwo is very tall.*
  - Modifying adverbs: *Maureen runs extremely fast.*
- **Types (Based on the questions they answer):**
  - How? = Adverb of manner
  - When? = Adverb of time
  - Why? = Adverb of reason
  - Where? = Adverb of place
  - How often? = Adverb of frequency
  - To what extent? = Adverb of degree
  - Under what condition? = Adverb of condition

WEEK 8

TOPICS: VOCABULARY: HOTEL & CATERING; STRUCTURE: PREPOSITIONAL PHRASES

Vocabulary Development: Hotel & Catering

- **Room service:** Service that lets guests have food/drinks delivered to their rooms.
- **Bars:** Where guests go to have a drink.
- **Brochure:** A small paper containing adverts of local attractions.
- **Continental breakfast:** A light breakfast served in a common area.
- **Buffet:** Consists of many different kinds of food where guests serve themselves.
- **Spa:** For relaxation; might offer massages or a sauna.
- **Reception (Front Desk):** Where guests are greeted and allotted rooms.
- **Banquet/Meeting room:** Large room used for big events like conferences or weddings.
- **Making reservation:** To book a room.
- **Check in:** To hire and enter a hotel room to stay.
- **Cuisine:** A characteristic style of preparing food (e.g., French cuisine).
- **Turndown service:** The remaking of beds by hotel attendants.

Structure: Prepositional Phrases

(See Week 4 notes for comprehensive rules on Prepositional Phrases).

WEEK 9

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: IDIOMS; VOCABULARY: POLITICS AND GOVERNMENT

Structure: Idioms

An idiom is a phrase whose meaning cannot be deduced from the individual meanings of the words in the phrase.

- **To play the ostrich:** Avoiding reality or danger.
- **To play God:** To act like you are all-powerful.
- **To leave no stone unturned:** To do everything possible.
- **To be on edge:** To be hot-tempered.
- **Icing on the cake:** Sample of the real thing / an added bonus.
- **To keep the flag flying:** Maintain a good impression.
- **To lead a dog's life:** To live in misery.
- **To keep body and soul together:** To survive.
- **To cook the books:** To falsify accounts.
- **In the red:** In debt, going bankrupt.
- **A fair-weather friend:** An unfaithful friend.
- **Chicken-hearted / liver-hearted:** Cowardly.
- **Feather-brain:** Foolish.
- **Eagle-eyed:** Very observant / very good sight.

Vocabulary Development: Words Associated with Politics and Government

- **Manifesto:** Programme of action or policy of a party.
- **Ballot-box:** Box into which voters put their ballot papers.
- **Suffrage:** Right to vote in a national election.
- **Primaries:** First stages of party election to select a candidate.
- **Nomination:** Act of naming a candidate for a post or office.
- **Aspirant:** Someone who desires to hold a political office.
- **Rigging:** Manipulating the votes to favour one candidate.

- **Votes:** Opportunities to indicate a choice of leader.
- **Election:** Choosing by vote.
- **Ballot:** Voting, votes.
- **Sovereign:** Self-governing, independent.
- **Party:** Association of people with a political aim.

WEEK 10

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: AFFIXATION (SUFFIXES); SPEECH WORK: NASAL SOUNDS; VOCABULARY: TRANSPORTATION

Structure: Affixation: Suffixes

The addition of suffixes to words creates new words and changes their word classes.

- **Verbs to Nouns:**
  - -ment (Enslavement, management)
  - -ion / -ation (Action, conclusion, organisation)
  - -age (Marriage, drainage)
  - -ist (Typist, separatist)
  - -er / -or (Teacher, director)
  - -ee (Amputee, employee)
  - -ant / -ing (Attendant, housing)
  - -ry / -ery / -ary (Brewery, refinery, dispensary)
- **Adjectives to Nouns:**
  - -ness (Usefulness, sadness)
  - -ity / -hood (Ethnicity, falsehood)
  - -ance / -ence (Importance, difference)
  - -ancy / -ency (Flippancy, efficiency)

Speech Work: Nasal Sounds (/m/, /n/, and /ŋ/)

- **/m/ (Bilabial Nasal):** Lips come together; air goes out through the nasal cavity (Man, mark, comb, comment).
- **/n/ (Alveolar Nasal):** Soft palate is lowered to cover the oral cavity. 'n' is silent when it occurs after 'm' in word-final positions (e.g., hymn, damn). (Nab, train, beginning).
- **/ŋ/ (Velar Nasal):** Produced like /n/ except the back of the tongue forms a closure with the velum. It does not occur at the beginning of words. (Bang, rang, singer, thank, bank, anxious).

Vocabulary Development: Transportation

- **Ocean liner:** A ship used to convey passengers across the ocean.
- **Berth:** Place for a ship to anchor.
- **Rudder:** A blade at the back of a ship that swings to control its direction.
- **Cargo:** Goods carried by a ship or vehicle.
- **Speedometer:** An instrument in a vehicle for telling its speed.
- **Chauffeur:** A person employed to drive someone's car.
- **Commuter:** A person who makes a regular journey of some distance.
- **Freightliner / Liner train:** A train that carries large amounts of goods in special containers.
- **Derail:** To cause to run off the railway lines.
- **Terminus:** The last stop on a railway.
- **Airliner:** A large passenger aircraft.
- **Fuselage:** The main body of an aircraft.
- **Cockpit:** The part of a plane where the pilot and co-pilot sit.
- **Tarmac / Runway:** A path for aircraft landing or taking off.
- **Terminal:** A station for passengers arriving from an airport.
- **Hangar:** A big building where planes are kept.

WEEK 11

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: CLAUSES; SPEECH WORK: 5TH & 6TH SYLLABLE STRESS; COMPREHENSION: IMPLIED MEANING

Structure: Clauses – Subordinate and Insubordinate

A clause is a group of words that has a subject and a finite verb.

- **Independent / Insubordinate Clauses:** Expresses a complete thought and can stand on its own as a sentence (e.g., *My English teacher is a kind man.*)
- **Dependent / Subordinate Clauses:** Does not express a complete thought and cannot stand on its own. It depends on an independent clause. Types include:
  - **Noun Clause:** Performs the functions of a noun (e.g., *What he said is bitter.*)
  - **Adjectival Clause:** Modifies a noun or pronoun (e.g., *The man who came here is a teacher.*)
  - **Adverbial Clause:** Performs the function of an adverb (e.g., *Ada saw him when she came to his office.*)

Speech Work: Stress on the 5th and 6th Syllables

- Words of five syllables that end in **-ion** have the stress placed on the second syllable from the back (adminisTRAtion, consideRAtion, communiCAtion).
- Words of five syllables that end in **-ity** have the stress placed on the third syllable from the back (authenTIcity, conducTIvity, possiBIlity).
- Words of six syllables that end in **-ion** or **-ity** are also stressed on the second and third syllable from the back respectively (personifiCAtion, intensifiCAtion, impossiBIlity, responsiBIlity).

Reading for Implied Meaning

- Writers often leave information openly unstated, expecting readers to piece together information to draw conclusions.
- **Strategies:** Read questions before, during, and after; link ideas to follow the line of thought; bring in background knowledge; test your conclusions against the information given.